H-A-00600A(GSA-FSS)
January 6, 1969
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. H-A-00600(GSA-FSS)
June 22, 1964

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

APPLICATOR, WAX

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, D.C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION.

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for a wax applicator with handle, pad holder, and replaceable pads made of natural lambskin wool cloth, for use in manual application of floor waxes.

1.2 Classification. The wax applicator covered by this specification shall be of one type, grade, and size.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

NN-H-104 - Handles, Wood, Acme Threaded and Circular Tapered End.
CCC-T-191 - Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies.)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 7920

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

National Bureau of Standards Handbooks:
H-28 - Screw Thread Standards for Federal Services.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20401.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample approval. When specified (see 6.1), before production is commenced, a sample of the wax applicator to be supplied shall be submitted to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval. The approval of the preproduction sample does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Block. The block shall be of smoothly finished, clear, close-grained hardwood and be of a two piece construction. The top section of the block shall be coated on all surfaces with transparent varnish, clear lacquer or other suitable organic coating. The bottom section of the block may also be coated.

3.2.2 Bolts and wing-nuts. The bolts and wing-nuts shall be made from a good commercial quality metal having a tensile strength suitable for the purpose intended. The metal shall be either inherently corrosion resistant or steel which has been zinc or cadmium coated. Coated steel shall show no evidence of corrosion when tested as specified in 4.5.1.

3.2.3 Pad. The pad shall be of natural lambskin wool or lambswool securely adhered to a knitted cotton cloth back having not less than 12 wales per inch and 21 courses per inch when tested as specified in 4.5. The back of the cotton knitted cloth shall be coated with a latex, synthetic latex or synthetic resin. Each finished lambskin wool or lambwool cloth pad shall weigh not less than 1-1/2 ounces and the wool pile shall be sheared evenly to a height of 3/4 plus or minus 1/8 inch. The finished pad shall measure 12 plus or minus 1/4 inches long and 6 plus or minus 1/4 inches wide.

3.2.4 Handle. The handle shall be of close-grain and straight-grained hardwood having an Acme threaded end. It shall conform to type 1, size 1, or 2, length 4-1/2 of NN-H-104 except as specified in 3.3.3.

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3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Block. The wood block used to secure the handle and pad shall be of two piece construction. The top section of the block shall have either a flat or convex face and shall measure 12 plus or minus 1/8 inches long and 2-1/2 plus or minus 1/8 inches wide. Flat face tops shall be not less than 3/4 inch thick. Blocks having convex tops shall be not less than 3/4 inch thick at the point of maximum thickness and not less than 5/8 inch in thickness at the point of minimum thickness. The top section of the block shall have a counter sunk standard Acme threaded handle hole machined to accommodate the handle specified in 3.3.3. The center of the boring shall be 6 inches from the end of the block and bored through the block at an angle that will permit the entire face of the pad to touch the surface of floor when in use. The perimeter of the staff hole shall extend to within 1/4 plus or minus 1/16 inch from the edge of the block. Two 1/4 inch diameter holes each approximately 2 inches from the ends of the block shall be drilled through the top section of the block to accommodate two bolts for attaching the bottom section of block. The bottom section of the block shall be flat, measuring 12 plus or minus 1/8 inches long, 2-1/2 inches wide with a minus tolerance of 1/8 inch and a plus tolerance of 1/2 inch, and not less than 3/8 inch in thickness. Two 3/16 or 1/4 inch diameter holes each approximately 2 inches from the ends of the bottom section of block, coinciding with the holes in the top section of the block, shall be drilled through the block to accommodate the bolts.

3.3.2 Bolts and wing-nuts. The bolts used for joining the top and bottom half sections of the block shall be size number 8-32 and measure not less than 1-3/4 inches in length over-all. They shall have flat heads not less than 3/8 inch in diameter. There shall be two wing-nuts having a thread to match that of the bolts for securing the pad between the top and bottom sections of the block. The bolts shall be threaded in accordance with "Screw Thread Standards for Federal Services, Unified National Coarse Thread, Series, Handbook H 28."

3.3.3 Handle. The handle shall conform to type 1, size 1 or 2, length 4-1/2 of NN-H-104 except that if necessary, the thread length shall be modified so that after assembly in the block, the threaded end will not protrude beyond the under surface of the block.

3.4 Marking for identification. The supplier shall permanently and legibly indent his name or trademark of such known character that it is easily identifiable with said manufacturer on the block of each wax applicator.

3.5 Workmanship. The wax applicator shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification and shall be free from defects which may affect durability, serviceability or appearance. The occurence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality level.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, inspection shall be made of the completed end item for conformance with all provisions of this specification.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection shall be performed in accordance with applicable specifications or shall meet the requirements of this specification. This specification shall govern in the event of conflict. Where applicable CCC-T-191 shall be used.

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4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for defects in design, material, construction and workmanship and be classified in accordance with table I. The lot for the purpose of examination shall be all complete units of applicators or all applicator pads (when pads are delivered separately) presented for delivery at one time. For sampling, complete applicators or pads shall be taken at random from each inspection lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level I and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one complete applicator or one pad as applicable.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Block	Not clear, smoothly finished close-grained hardwood.	X	
	Dimensions of block not as specified.	X	
	Diameter of holes not as specified.		X
	Block not coated as specified.	X	
	Hole to receive Acme threaded handle not as specified.	X	
Bolts and wing-nuts	Dimensions not as specified.	X	
	Metal not as specified.	X	
	Coated metal pitted or discolored.	X	
Handle	When assembled in block, handle protrudes beyond under surface of block.	X	
Pad	Dimension not as specified.	X	
	Material not as specified.	X	
	Pile not evenly sheared.		X
	Pile not of specified height.	X	
	Weight of pad less than specified.	X	
Component parts	Missing, defective, damaged or broken	X	
Identification marking	Missing, incorrect, illegible or distorted	X	

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking requirements comply with section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of contents the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence; or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose bands; inadequate sealing. Bulging or distortion of container.

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4.5 Testing of the end item. The methods of testing shall be as specified in table III and 4.5.1. The lot for the purpose of testing shall be all complete units of applicators or all applicator pads (when pads are delivered separately) presented at one time. For sampling, complete applicators or pads shall be taken at random from each inspection lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one complete applicator or one pad as applicable.

TABLE III. Test methods

Characteristics	Reference paragraph	CCC-T-191 Test method
Identification of wool	3.2.3	1100
Identification of cotton	3.2.3	1200
Wales and courses	3.2.3	5070
Weight of cloth	3.2.3	5040

4.5.1 Corrosion test. Hardware fabricated of coated ferrous metal shall be placed in a boiling 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride for a period of not less than 15 minutes. The hardware upon being removed from the solution shall be immediately immersed for at least 1 hour in 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride at room temperature of 68 to 85 degrees F. Hardware shall then be removed from this solution and, without having the adhering liquid wiped off, allowed to dry for 24 hours at room temperature (68°F. to 85°F.) and then wiped free of any residue and examined for compliance with 3.2.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve complete applicators with upper and lower sections of the block joined together with bolts and wing nuts and with handles disassembled, or 72 refill pads (see 6.1) shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class 2, W5c. Each box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve complete applicators with upper and lower sections of the block joined together with bolts and wing nuts and with handles disassembled, or 72 refill pads (see 6.1) shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except waterproof sealing with tape shall not be required and the box shall be class, domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The applicators and refill pads shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Four unit packages of applicators or six unit packages or refill pads shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class 2, V3c, style RSC. Each box shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Four unit packages of applicators or six unit packages or refill pads shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except that waterproof sealing with tape and reinforcing with bands of filament tape shall not be required and the box shall be class, domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

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5.2.3 Level C. The applicators and refill pads shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(c) When refill pads are required only.
(d) Selection of applicable packaging and packing levels (see 5.1 and 5.2).

DOD coordination waived.

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GSA DC 69-8674